

The team project: create a digital marketing agency

You work in a team of four or five. Your team creates a digital marketing agency and builds what an agency needs: a website, a list of clients, emails and a plan to win work.

The agency is not a real business. It has no real clients, it spends no money, and nothing is sent to a real person.

Your team decides what kind of agency it is

It can be any kind of agency, as long as it sells digital marketing services. Your team also decides who its clients are. Do the research before you decide. Look at who buys these services, what they pay for now, and which agencies already sell to them.

Your agency needs nine things

1	A target audience	The kind of company your agency sells to, and the person in that company who decides. You research this before you choose.
2	Commercial goals	The revenue and the profit your agency is aiming for.
3	Positioning	What your agency does, who it is for, and why a client would pick you and not another agency.
4	Messaging	What you say to that client, in words they would use themselves.
5	A website	You design it, write the words and make the pictures.
6	A CRM	The tool that holds your clients and the companies you want as clients. We use Attio.
7	Email	The tool that sends your emails, and the emails you would send. We use Klaviyo.
8	A plan to get clients	How companies find you and how you reach them: search, AI tools such as ChatGPT, ads, posts and messages you write to companies.
9	Agents working for you	At least three marketing agents that do the work of your agency. Your team chooses which jobs.

Agents do the work of your agency

Your agency does not have to sell agents to its clients. But your team must use agents to run the agency. A marketing agent is an AI that does one marketing job for you. Asking Claude a question in a chat window is not an agent. An agent has a name and one job, and the job is written down: what it reads, what it does, and where it puts its work. We build the first ones together in class 4.

You use everything you learn twice

Each week you learn one part of digital marketing. You use it to market your own agency. It is also a service your agency can sell to its clients. For example, you learn how to build a website. Your agency needs a website, and your agency can build websites for clients.

Every team gets the same made-up data

It is a list of made-up companies and people for the CRM tool, Attio, and a list of made-up email subscribers for the email tool, Klaviyo. There are no real people in it, and nothing is sent to a real person.

The marks

The project is your portfolio, and you add to it every week. The portfolio is 20% of your mark. Your team builds it each week from the work on your agency. Your mark is your own. It comes from two things: your team's project, and what your teammates say about the work you did. At the end, each of you fills in a short form about who did what in your team. The written exam is 80%. You sit it on your own, and you must pass the exam to pass the module.

The dates

Monday 12 October	The project is explained. Teams are set.
Monday 19 October	Your team chooses its marketing agents. You set up Claude on your laptop in class.
2 and 9 November	You build the website and do the GEO, the paid search plan, the ads and the posts.
Later in November	You set up your customers in Attio, write your outbound messages and write your emails in Klaviyo. The days are to be confirmed.
The last class	Each team presents its agency to Paul and shows the practical work it has done. The day is to be confirmed.

Before Monday 19 October, your team should be able to say in one sentence who its agency would sell to. You need a laptop from that day.